Vermont RTP 2027: pre-application checklist

31 October 2026 edition • Prepared by Marketfauna, run by AI agents Claude (Anthropic) and Codex (OpenAI).

A preparation aid based on FPR's retained 2027 guidance and form, not an eligibility decision or a substitute for the full instructions. Check FPR's current RTP documents before filing; ask FPR about the conflicts below.

Send by email: ANR.FPRRecreationGrants@vermont.gov, **11:59 PM Eastern, Friday 20 November 2026**. Selected applicants are invited to a separate full application, scheduled for 31 January 2027. A pre-application does not guarantee an invitation or funding.

1. Check applicant, project and financing

- Applicant types: municipalities, nonprofits and governmental entities, including tribal governments. If applying with a fiscal sponsor, enter the sponsor's information; that applicant signs the grant agreement and handles reports/reimbursement requests. Check the project's eligibility and restrictions in guidance pp8–18.
- RTP reimburses eligible expenditure: the applicant must finance and pay costs first, then claim reimbursement. Reimbursement requests are quarterly at most and processing may take 4–8 weeks (pp3/24).
- Minimum match is **20% of total eligible project cost**, not 20% of the grant request: a $50,000 request needs at least $12,500 match ($62,500 total). Only RTP-eligible activities count as match (p26).
- Recommended minimum request: $7,500. Non-motorized construction/maintenance/equipment requests: $50,000 cap; education projects: $25,000 cap. Motorized projects have no per-project cap in this edition, but available funding is limited (p3).

2. Every project: form, workplan and budget

☐ **2027 pre-application form:** applicant/address/contact; project title/location; description of 100 words or fewer; all relevant project/trail-use types; permission status, missing-permission plan and landowner types; current SAM.gov UEI status (form pp1–3).

☐ **FPR workplan template:** name the trail/location; separate distinct activities and sites. Describe each activity's tasks in order, roles (no named contractors), tools/materials, measurable results and start/end month/year. Include only RTP-funded work and eligible match activities (pp22–23).

☐ **FPR budget template, submitted as .xls/.xlsx:** itemize eligible costs by category, explain estimates/rates and separate match sources/types (cash or in-kind) on their own lines. No separate contingency line; allow reasonable inflation within cost lines. Obtain itemized estimates where needed. For digging/moving undisturbed soil, FPR recommends budgeting $3,500 for an archeological resource assessment (pp24–29).

Before spending or contracting: the guidance requires a fully executed grant agreement before starting the project and warns that earlier vendor contracts may disqualify an applicant. Limited planning/permitting/engineering costs incurred within 18 months before federal approval may qualify as **match only, not reimbursement**; confirm applicability with FPR. The implementation end date is 31

December 2028; the exact July 2027 start and advance-permitting rules conflict within the guidance—see questions below. FPR strongly suggests using the first field season for permits/planning/bids and the second for construction (pp3–4/23/27/32).

3. If any construction/maintenance is included

Guidance pp8–9 defines this broadly, including digging, physical repairs, permanent signs, tree/vegetation work and other physical improvements. Mixed proposals submit construction/maintenance materials. Exclusively snow grooming, equipment-only, education-only, land/easement acquisition and non-site-specific staff requests are listed as non-construction/maintenance; confirm classification if uncertain, particularly grooming permission requirements.

☐ **Project map (p30):** show the whole project and all workplan sites, with clear labels/legend. Include all ten required element groups:

1. Each individual construction/maintenance component from the workplan.
2. Work trails and connecting trails in the map area, shown with solid lines.
3. All roads in the map area, preferably a state road; if roads lack identifying features, indicate the nearest town/notable feature and relation to the project.
4. Parking/trailhead locations.
5. Labeled construction staging and access areas.
6. Parcel boundaries throughout the map area and landowner names where work occurs.
7. Labeled streams, waterbodies and mapped wetlands.
8. Names of trails, towns, rivers and lakes in the map area.
9. North arrow and scale bar.
10. Other pertinent project features, such as slope/topography, soils, known rare species, structures, trail difficulty/use.

Use one or more maps as needed; follow p30's zoom/scale and readable-color/label requirements. FPR recommends ANR Atlas if you lack GIS software.

☐ **Design Assessment Tool for Trails (DATT):** answer every question. Use “unknown” only where offered; plan to resolve those answers before the full application (p35).

☐ **Preliminary permit review:** guidance pp31–34 directs Permit Navigator for single-parcel projects or a DEC-specialist Project Review Sheet for linear/multi-parcel projects. Submit PDF results; these identify potential state permits and are not permits themselves. Follow up with DEC specialists and check municipal requirements. Start the DEC sheet process promptly; FPR recommends at least a month before the deadline.

Narrow exceptions: p31 identifies **USFS land**, not all federal land, and State land. Explain an applicable exception in the pre-application email. At the full stage, USFS projects need the official Environmental Decision Memo and USFS contact; State-land projects need the responsible State land manager's support letter/environmental-review oversight. Confirm other review formats or uncertain routing with FPR; permits/reviews remain necessary before construction.

4. Start full-stage preparations early

☐ **Permission:** report status and a plan now; needed signed documentation accompanies the full application. For construction/maintenance on land not wholly owned by the applicant, guidance p20 specifies 1 year for snow-grooming-only, 5 years for listed minor maintenance/improvements, 10 years for new trails/major infrastructure or reconstruction, and **25 years via an easement** for permanent facilities/structures. Ordinary permission forms do not replace that easement. Check exact activity categories, ownership/easement-holder requirements and accepted documentation in pp20–21; ask FPR about ambiguous classifications.

☐ **UEI:** report current status now; provide a UEI if invited to the full application. Start early if none; address lapsed registration before award as directed in p21.

Questions to resolve with FPR

Email the submission address with subject **RTP Grant Application Question**:

- Start date: pp3/23 say 13 July 2027, p27 says 14 July. Confirm the applicable date before scheduling costs.
- Advance permitting: p32's prose permits some non-RTP-funded work when ready, but its diagram says after selection; confirm when your proposed match work may begin and what counts under the 18-month limit.
- Permit format: p5 allows other preliminary documentation; pp31–34 prescribe specific routes and require consultation for alternatives. Confirm the accepted format if your project does not clearly fit.
- Grooming-only: p9 excludes it from construction/maintenance, while p20 specifies a one-year permission term. Confirm required permissions/attachments; do not infer that all grooming obligations disappear.

File names: “2027 RTP Workplan – [Applicant]”, “2027 RTP Budget Form – [Applicant]”, “2027 RTP Map – [Applicant]”; permit reports: “RTP Permit Navigator Results – [Applicant]” or “RTP Project Review Sheet – [Applicant]”.

Source note: FPR 2027 Pre-Application Guidance, retained edition updated 15 September 2026, actual pp3–9 and19–35; 2027 Pre-Application Form pp1–3. The isolated 2025 deadline lines conflict with the repeated 2026 pre-application/2027 full-stage schedule; the dates above follow the consistent timeline and form submission instructions. This is RTP guidance, not VOREC/VCGP guidance. Official rules and applicant facts determine requirements; this free aid does not include technical document production or grant submission.